New Dundee Public School - School Council Agenda/Minutes

Date: March 30, 2025
Time: 7:00 p.m. – 8:00 p.m.

Meeting Link: https://calendar.app.google/4PPmbgL3gVr1n21UA

School Council Handbook: School Council Handbook

Introductions and Attendance

- **Principal:** Joshua Kirk
- **Staff:** Kelly Willig
- **Chair:** Sarah Cherry
- **Secretary:** Sarah Cherry for Melissa Kristensen
- **Treasurer:** Sarah Benn

- **School Council:** Jessica Nartey, Keizo Mauri
- **Guests:** Maria Dotzert
- **Student:** none
- **Regrets:** Melissa Kristensen

Welcome / Territory Acknowledgment

As we gather virtually this evening, we would like to honor the existence of the First Peoples by acknowledging that we are on the traditional land of the Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and Mississauga peoples. New Dundee Public School occupies the land of the Between the Lakes Treaty from 1792. As learners, we continue to understand this place has significance to the First Peoples because of the rolling hills, forests, flat land, and the proximity to the Nith and Grand River, which is fed by the Great Lakes. Settlers need to take responsibility to continue our education and honor of the First Peoples. Let's work to honor the Dish with One Spoon covenant, a peace agreement made between the Indigenous nations before the settlers arrived. It characterizes our collective responsibility to each other and to Mother Earth. We should only take what we need and leave enough for future generations.

Principal's Report

Updates

- Thank you to School Council for organizing and running a successful Rheo Thompson fundraiser just in time for Easter
- We have hired a new Temporary Head Custodian, Ms. Martinez, who will be with us until December 2026 when our Head Custodian Laura Lister returns ● Term 2 IEPs have been distributed to families of students with IEPs ● We have a busy spring coming up with lots of events – see below for list of dates ● Enrolment next year looks fairly similar to this year – we are down a bit in Kindergarten – registration is still open
- Over the next few weeks I will begin looking at class organization for next year as as well as teaching assignments
- Teachers will participate in the internal staffing process as applicable ● We have started transition conversations with SAB for our Grade 6 students ● Lost & Found items are piling up. Teachers will bring classes down to have a look at the items before donating back to the community if not claimed.
- Council survey will be coming from the Board sometime in May.

Important Dates

- April 3 - Good Friday
- April 6 - Easter Monday
- April 13 - Tornado Drill
- April 17 - Twin Day
- April 24 - PD Day
- May 4 - Fire Drill #4
- May 6 - Fire Drill #5
- May 11 - Fire/Bomb Drill
- May 13 - Dental Screening (JK, SK, & Gr. 2)
- May 14 - Dragon Run
- May 15 - Grade 6 Visit to SAB
- May 22 - Jump Rope for Heart
- May 25 - School Council
- May 25 -29 - Grade 6 EQAO
- May 28 - Welcome to School for JK Students
- June 2-5 - Grade 3 EQAO
- June 8 - Track and Field (Rain Date June 9)
- June 12 - Volunteer Breakfast

- June 15 - Regional Track and Field
- June 18 - Grade 6 Celebration
- June 19 - Staff Appreciation Lunch?
- June 22 - New Dundee Fun Fair
- June 25 - Last Day of School
- June 26 - PD Day

Action item:

- Event for students to attend during Staff Appreciation Lunch to be discussed. Ideas welcome.

What are we fundraising for?

- Bussing for field trips
- Nutrition for learning
    - Soup cook-off fundraiser at St. James Lutheran Church raised $750 and the church matched it, for a total donation of $1,500.
- Playground equipment repairs/replacement
    - Attach as a goal to each fundraising event
    - Josh has reached out to the facilities manager; they will come out in the spring. Date to be communicated to council so a representative can be present at the meeting with facilities to ask any questions.
    - Playground Fundraising Event - JUNE 22, rain date of June 23, 5pm-8pm.

Action Items:

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Fundraising Plans and Ideas for 2025 - 2026

<u>Current Plans:</u>

- **Veggie Boxes:** September - $700 raised
- **Bookfair**: November
    - Scholastic points are used to purchase items for the school, determined by the staff

    - $1,637.25 raised
- **Dance-A-Thon:**
    - February 13
    - Total Donations: $1,993.85
        - $1,328.85 online donations
        - $665.00 cash donations
        - Left over glow items to be used at next years dance a thon as well could be sold at the end of year event.
- **Chocolate (Rheo Thompson):**
    - March
    - Raised $1,451.99
    - Hiccups due to counting and names not being on forms. Ideally the next fundraiser is on-line for simplicity.
- **Used Book Sale:**
    - Will take place at the end of year event. Kelly Willig to take the lead on this.
    - Would like to choose a date to have families drop off book donations to the school. If the date doesn't work, Kelly could arrange to have the books dropped of to her house.
    - Drop off date to be determined.
- **End of year event:** BBQ - **Planned for June 22, rain date of June 23** ○ Start Planning! Organize a committee. Send out letters and notices. ■ Pizza from Dominos in New Hamburg.
        - Sarah C to meet with Optimist Club to ask for funds to cover the cost of some food items. Optimist Club is unable to BBQ for us, therefore we have decided to go with pizza. Easier logistically and less red tape with the school board and food safety rules.
        - Used Book Sale
        - Silent Auction
        - Fun outdoor games
        - Music
- **2026 book fair date**: November 2-6, 2026
- Mabel's Labels fundraising code - Sarah Benn to inquire how to received funds from sales. Josh to send a reminder via school day as a reminder about the ongoing fundraiser.

Action Items:

- Sarah C & Josh to discuss and finalize details regarding end of year playground

kick off event.

- Email to follow to vote on a name for the event.
- Communications will be sent via school day once everything has been finalized.

Financial Report

School Council Funds Summary		
March 2026		
Main Account		
Opening balance - June 2025	3,793.09	
Herrle's fundraiser - orders	3,787.32	
Herrle's fundraiser - expense	-3,080.00	
Scholastic book fair - net cash	169.23	
Bussing for field trips (prior school year)	713.34	Transferred from WEFI
Gym equipment	-1,284.85	
Dance a thon - glow items	97.64	
Rheo Thompson - orders	5,390.50	
Rheo Thompson - expense	-3,707.98	
Balance in account at March 27, 2026	**5,878.28**	
WEFI Account		
Bussing for field trips (prior school year)	- 713.34	Transferred from main account
Bussing for field trips (current school year)	-203.70	Benjamin Tree Farm trip - rooms 1, 2, 9
Bussing for field trips (current school year)	-203.70	Waterloo Region Airport trip - room 4
Bussing for field trips (current school year)	-280.94	January 2026 - Hamilton Family Theatre
Dance a thon	1,993.85	

- $140.80 in the School Council Float
- Add playground equipment as fundraising goal for every fundraiser from now on - that way any extra $ can be put towards the playground
- Any money coming out of WEFI goes to finance and we have to have documentation
- Nutrition for Learning - need approval to send cheque for 2026 fundraiser (Rheo). Also need to approve a cheque for last year's fundraiser (Baden Coffee, $496.30).
- Sarah C motioned to approve to send funds from Baden Coffee fundraiser to Nutrition for Learning. Sarah B seconded.

Action item:

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Volunteer

- Thank-you to all the parents that volunteered at the dance-a-thon!

Action item:

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Ongoing Programs and Other Updates

- Nutrition for Learning
    - No update this meeting
- Strong Start
    - Spring session has started
    - Celebration for both sessions at the end of the spring session
- Gardens
    - Discuss clean-up date for early May (not discussed, will send via email)
    - Put a call out to NDPS grads for volunteer help
- Care Committee - Kelly
    - Nothing to report

Action item:

- Email to discuss garden clean up

WRAPSC/PIC Meeting Update

<u>WRAPSC</u>

January 2026 meeting minutes have not been posted.

Sarah B attended part of the WRAPSC meeting in February. A few points:

- Can use school council funds for wiggle stools, sensory tools etc. for higher needs kids, even if an assessment/OT order was not done (ask educators if they need these resources)
- Discussed some ideas for active events we could put on with school council funds: Guelph Grotto (climbing walls), JungleSport (mobile gym), DrumFit - they come and set up at the school and the classes cycle through for the day, gives teachers a break/planning time
- Playground: Facilities can provide some funds for playground replacements. Mention of a “secret list” of schools with aging playgrounds where board will provide funds. Southbridge, Carmichael may have received funds. Asked for more details, still waiting.

Josh & Sarah C. have the updated poster for the PIC event.

Action Items:

- Josh to ask teachers if they need new sensory activities, council could assist with the purchase.
- Josh advised we don't qualify for special funding from the board for the playground due to the accessibility improvements the school is undergoing for the elevator installation.
- Sarah C to look into grants for playground improvements.

Upcoming meetings

- Sep 25, 2025 - PIC - 6:30pm
- Nov 4, 2025 - WRAPSC - 7:00pm
- Nov 25, 2025 - PIC - 6:30pm
- Jan 6, 2026 - WRAPSC - 7:00pm
- Jan 27, 2025 - PIC - 6:30pm (Sarah C)
- Feb 3, 2026 - WRAPSC - 7:00pm (Sarah B)
- Mar 24, 2026 - PIC - 6:30pm
- Apr 7, 2026 - WRAPSC - 7:00pm
- May 5, 2026 - WRAPSC - 7:00pm
- May 26, 2026 - PIC - 6:30pm

Action Items:

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2024 - 2025 School Council Dates

- September 22
- November 10
- January 19
- March 30
- May 25

Meeting Minutes Approval

- Motion by Sarah Cherry, Seconded by Sarah Benn

Please email the chair or administration with any agenda requests before the next meeting: sewrustic@gmail.com, joshua_kirk@wrdsb.ca, ndpscouncil@gmail.com

Topics from last year for future meetings

- Grade 6 transition
- Staff appreciation lunch
- EQAO snacks